TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
BUDGET WORKSHOP AND
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2023
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Sharon O'Conner, 220 Bonaventure Rd., discussed the issue of speed on Bonaventure Rd. She states the speed limit is 25 MPH, but people speed at 40+ MPH regularly. She voiced her fear of pulling out of her driveway because she doesn't think it is safe. She feels more patrol and ticketing will help matters.

Lisa Yarbrough, 314 Bonaventure Rd., mentioned she has spoken to several officers over the years regarding the speeding problem on Bonaventure Rd. She feels that very few people abide by the posted speed limit. She also mentioned the use of Bonaventure Rd. by tractor trailers and trucks pulling large trailers. She voiced her displeasure regarding repair work done under the road that has caused the road to be unlevel and it is pushing dirt in her yard when trucks drive by. She discussed having a special needs child and she feels the speeding issue is a safety concern for him. She also mentioned that the busses speed on Bonaventure Rd.

Town Administrator Milie acknowledged the speeding concerns and discussed the state law that prohibits the Thunderbolt Police Department from running radar on Bonaventure Rd. due to the posted speed limit being 25 MPH. He also discussed future safety features to be added in 2024 to help deter speeding along Bonaventure Rd.

Jan Yarbrough, 24 Bonaventure Rd., asked about the November 1, 2023 Special Called Planning and Zoning meeting that was held. She voiced not seeing it advertised on the home page of the Town's website. She also questioned whether proper advertisement and neighbor notification letters went out in accordance with the law.

Town Administrator Milie and Interim Town Clerk, Matthew Walker, explained that the meeting was advertised in the Savannah Morning News, posted on the Town's website in the proper location, and that notification letters were sent to all abutting propery owner's that required a notice to be sent.

Trey Conners, 3211 Bannon Dr., voiced his displeasure with speeding and the use of tractor trailers in the residential area around Bannon Dr. He stated that there are 37 tractor trailers, on average, that pass on Bannon Dr. each day.

Town Administrator Milie stated the one-way use of Bannon Dr. was to allow trucks to arrive at their destination in Town. It was also a safety measure to prevent possible collisions.

Mayor Williams closed the public hear meeting at 6:30 pm.

Mayor Williams opened the 2024 Budget Workshop at 6:30 pm.

Mayor Williams stated that money, time, and effort will be directed to reduce speeding in Thunderbolt in 2024.

Town Administrator Milie discussed funding for an additional officer in 2024. He stated that speed enforcement cameras are only allowed in school zones. He addressed council member Crenshaw's desire to add ADA compliant sidewalks and to complete road repairs and maintenance around Thunderbolt. He addressed council member Ward's desire to add beautification projects around town. He also discussed Mayor Williams' wish to have more community involvement by hosting block parties and gatherings to bring the community together as well as improving the infrastructure. He also addressed council member Drohan's desire for improved sustainability, the use of solar power, and the need for a pickleball court in Thunderbolt. Mr. Milie addressed council member Lavin's concerns about litter and program management for maintenance. He also addressed council member Barbaree's wish to increase beautification and to have more community events to interface with the residents.

Mayor Williams discussed the 300% increase in costs to pave roads at this time.

Dr. Drohan added that raw materials are higher in cost, but there may be alternatives. He also asked if the additional police officer would help with the speeding concerns around Thunderbolt.

Police Chief Clayton said adding another officer will help with scheduling and enforcement.

Mayor Williams closed the budget workshop at 6:45.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order -** Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:45pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Wiliams and Council Members: David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Edward Drohan, James Lavin and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow, Polie Chief, Sean Clayton; Utilities Clerk, Renee Holmes, Accounts Payable/Utilities Manager, Katina Spaulding; Interim Clerk of Council, Matthew Walker.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

   Minutes of October 11, 2023

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes October 11, 2023. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with meeting minutes October 11, 2023. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

   Retired Educator's Day Proclamation – Mayor Williams presented the Retired Educator's Day proclamation to five representatives of the Chatham Retired Educators Association.

6. **Finance Report:**

Shannon Brett, Holland, Bromley, Barnhill & Brett, discussed a new GA Prime Fund that could possibly interest the Town. She also discussed the 5-year look back at the Town's financials.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

Consideration to Approve River Drive Crossfit outdoor event for December 16, 2023. **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve River Drive Crossfit outdoor event for December 16, 2023. Council Member Barbaree provided the second. Motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Consideration to Approve Town Hall Recognition Program - **A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to Approve Town Hall Recognition Program. Council Member Ward provided the second. Motion passed unanimously.**

b) **Discussion of Massage Parlor Ordinance to help prevent and combat human trafficking.**

Town Administrator Milie discussed the current allowing of spas in some areas of Thunderbolt. He wishes to create an Ordinance to make it more difficult for illegal/illegitimate spa services to open businesses in the Town. Attorney Barrow and Council Member Drohan believe the Ordinance needs to be more specific to include what is not allowed.

c) **Discussion of Georgia Gang Database Training at Traffick Jam 2024.**

Town Administrator Milie discussed the need for an Intergovernmental Agreement with the state to gain access to the state's gang database.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police

Chief Clayton had nothing further to add to his report. Chief Clayton stated he will move the speed sign to Bonaventure Rd. to have a study done on the traffic and speeding concerns. He believes the Town should define "residential" area for speed limit issue. He also discussed the means to send applicants to the police academy for training.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Chief Bateman was not in attendance and no report was given.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Public Works Director Crosby was not in attendance and no report was given.

10. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie went over some highlights from his report. He discussed the dry creek bed for the Tompson Park fountain was out for bids.

11. **Legal Report** – No report

12. **Mayor and Council** – No report

13. **Thunderbolt Museum**

    Anna Maria Thomas stated there will be an event in January to benefit the Thunderbolt Museum. More detailed information will be available as the date approaches.

14. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to recess into executive session. Council Member Ward provided the second. Motion passes unanimously.**

    Mayor Williams asked for a motion to open back into the regular meeting. **Council Member Drohan asked for the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. Motion passes unanimously.**

    Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Adjournment:**

    The meeting adjourned at 8:27 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Interim Clerk of Council

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **8th** day **of November, 2023.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **8th** day of **November, 2023** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This **8th** day of **November, 2023.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Council Members

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this **8th** day of **November, 2023.**

Notary Public

MATTHEW D WALKER NOTARY PUBLIC Comm. Exp. 10/04/26 CHATHAM COUNTY, GA